

LISTEX SKI TV - SNOWCARBON.CO.UK - DANIEL ELKAN INTERVIEW

Ski TV here at our studio at LISTX and LISTX International Snow Sports Exchange and I have as my guest today Daniel Elkin and he's from Snow Carbon which is a fantastic resource if you're traveling to the Alps by rail. Daniel, tell us a bit about the project and how did it all get started? I guess it started about 20 years ago and in fact when I first went skiing with friends didn't know anything about how to go skiing and they said be it Gatwick five in the morning and I was there and then I imagined it'd be a quick hop to the slopes and it took ages and I thought maybe that's a one-off but every every time we went by plane it would take so long and then I realized that actually you can get the Alps quite quickly and very enjoyably by train. Yes and the train trips are just so fantastically beautiful when you're going there and I've done a massive train trip to St. Anton back in the early 2000s and I was just blown away by the scenery and it's not like getting on a normal train where it's a bit boring I mean you look out the window it just blows your mind and and your service people can go to your site and they can see everything in one place right? That's the aim yeah try and make it as as comprehensive as possible but also like insightful because it's it's really written you know five skiers four skiers if you like that journey to St. Anton is absolutely fantastic yeah I mean the yeah you know ringside seat on these lakes that you go past and yeah you know it's a longer journey than flying but it's not that much longer and it's so much more enjoyable more sustainable more comfortable more social but what I found and the reason I set Snow Carbon up is you know I was writing about the subject as a ski journalist but I would still find that it's such a wild goose chase sometimes to try and find out the information you need in order to make a decision about can I get to this resort by train or just like where can I go by train which resorts can you get to so with Snow Carbon we try and you know get really useful information put it in one place in a way that's that's really useful for skiers to use there are so many fantastic resorts in the Alps that you can reach by train and the people are discovering you don't need to fly or drive to reach the slopes when you travel by train it's a totally different experience I think there's a lot of pressure on on anyone who's organizing a ski holiday to get things absolutely right for their family or a group of friends everyone wants to enjoy the mountains in a different way every group is unique what Snow Carbon is doing is helping people with the key choices providing personal tailored advice on which resort where to stay and how to get there by train there's no secret that people love train travel you step on board it's started the journey becomes part of the whole day saves a hell of a lot of time because I mean you'd have to do all that work yourself individually over and over and over again and they can just go to your site and it's all there for you and and let's face it these days I mean I came here to London on Eurostar from Amsterdam and it's it's amazing because these days a lot of the if you're going from the UK for instance a lot of the border control for these countries is done on one one side yet whereas you don't have to go through all the security on both sides as you do when you're flying yeah it's a fantastic thing because yeah you know if you come on Eurostar to London for instance all the border checks are in Amsterdam yeah and then you get off in London and there's a little check

because you've already done it yeah you just walk into some pancakes that's done that's yeah and would it be the same sort of way you save a lot in the Alps as well because you go through a lot of those checks on one side is that how it works if you're going on a on the direct ski train then yeah the out the checks is just done in the in the Alps if you go in directly you know maybe going back via Paris then it's done in in Paris you know your point about the fact that research can take so long you know like the longer something takes me to research in a way it's it's satisfying to know that you know something took me four hours to find out okay maybe I can I'm saving each person four hours by putting out on the site so yeah it's a nice way to think about it yeah it's nice and and what I really love about being on the train is you you can relax you can walk around you can go to the bar you can stretch your legs and you can do a lot of work I mean coming over here I cleaned up my entire desktop which was like full of stuff just not organized and you can do things like that it's your mobile office too on the train I think that's that's the thing it's like you know you're gonna have these big chunks of time whereas you know if you try to work through a journey by playing it stop start stop start okay now we're moving to the carousel now we're moving here now we're moving you never really get into it whereas you know sit down on CGV get a coffee from the from the cafe bar clear up your desktop yeah you know and a scenery glides by yeah it's great it's good thinking time and it's really great social time you know I normally organize one or two ski holidays just for friends about 20 of us will go and I'll find a chalet that we can get to by train and not everyone knows each other because I've been buying friends and they might invite a couple of friends and stuff and starting at some pancreas you know the excitement and that's you know we pop open the bubbles and you know it's coffee and then you know you make a little picnic on the train and by the time you've got to the chalet everyone's become friends oh yes and in such a good relaxed mood you know yes the flying as you know is so stressful these days and waiting in those cubes I remember once I was stuck in a Geneva queue on a Sunday and seriously yeah the the snaking queues that go forever and ever you just don't get that on the train it's just not a experience that you want to get never want to go through the experience trust me try to avoid flying on a Sunday when it's changeover day yeah it's like crazy but on the train you don't have that kind of problem you don't know pick any time you like yeah how can people find more online about your service well the website snow carbon.co.uk and on the site you can find you know there's a whole there's a lot of destinations in terms of the great resorts you can get to in different countries there's a journey planner on the site for each resort so you can see you can look up further in advance than you can on rail company websites because I kind of do a predictive timetable okay and yeah there's a lot of information and it's it's snow carbon.co.uk fantastic it's a great service Daniel thank you for doing that I'm a big rail fan I think the way it is with COVID nowadays I think it's and to help save the planet rail journeys are the way to go in the future